❖ To express an action in progress at some point of time in the past when another event took place

e.g. She was cooking when the guests arrived.

❖ To describe two or more actions continuing at the same time

e.g. While I was watching T.V., he was sleeping.

❖ To indicate a frequently repeated action or persistent habit in the past

e.g. Nithish was constantly complaining about something or the other.

Forms and Uses of Past Perfect Tense

	First person	Second person	Third person
Affirmative			
***Singular**	I **had** already **sung.**	You **had** already **sung**	She/He/It **had** already **sung**
***Plural**	We **had** already **sung**	You **had** already **sung**	They had already **sung**

Uses

❖ For an action that had been completed before another action began in the past

e.g. He had appealed to the manager for a week's leave before I reached.

❖ To describe an action or event which has been completed before some point of time.

e.g. By 11 a.m. all the students had left the school campus after the Independence Day celebration.

❖ To describe an action in the past which became the cause of another action

❖ To describe an action in the past using the time adverbials such as already, since, before, etc.

❖ To express an unfulfilled action in the past and unfulfilled wish in the past.

e.g. If he had informed her, she would have waited for him.

I wish I had accepted the job.

Forms and Uses of Past Perfect Continuous Tense

	First person	Second person	Third person
Affirmative			
***Singular**	I **had been singing for** two hours yesterday**.**	You **had been singing for** two hours yesterday.	She/He/It **had been singing for** two hours yesterday.
***Plural**	We **had been singing for** two hours yesterday**.**	You **had been singing for** two hours yesterday.	They **had been singing for** two hours yesterday.

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